CAC MASTERS SERIES

CAC. 701

CHILD DEVELOPMENT THEORIES

MASTER IN CHILDREN AND ADOLESCENT COUNSELING

TRIUNE BIBLICAL UNIVERSITY GLOBAL EXTENSION USA

CHILD DEVELOPMENT THEORIES

CAC. 701

Child Development Theories

CAC. 701 · First Semester · 1.6 units · A complete lecture course for a sixteen-week semester

TRIUNE BIBLICAL UNIVERSITY GLOBAL EXTENSION USA

First Edition · 2026

Student Handbook of Comprehensive Lectures
Master in Children and Adolescent Counseling

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DEDICATION

To the children and young people who sit in the room and are not yet sure whether they can be helped —

and to the counsellors who learn to be worth trusting.

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About This Book

This volume is the complete lecture course for **CAC. 701 Child Development Theories**, a First Semester core course of the Master in Children and Adolescent Counseling, carrying 1.6 units. It is written to be taught from and studied from without any other material in the room.

What the course is for

Every other course in the programme will teach you something to do with a child or an adolescent. This one teaches you why doing it might work, and how you would know whether it did. A counselling theory is not a belief system and not a loyalty; it is a set of answers to four hard questions — what a child is, what maintains the difficulty, by what mechanism change occurs, and what the counsellor therefore does. Answered well, those questions make practice deliberate, teachable and defensible to the parent, the school, the court or the licensing board that asks what you did and why. Answered badly or not at all, practice becomes a series of intuitive moves that cannot be evaluated and cannot be revised when they fail.

The course moves through the four great lineages of counselling theory — psychodynamic and attachment, behavioural and cognitive, humanistic and existential, systemic and family — reading each against the same four questions, and ends where practice actually lives: in the integration of competing accounts into a formulation for one particular child, held to the standard of the available evidence.

How the semester is organised

Sixteen weeks. Weeks 1 to 14 teach. Week 15 integrates: a comparative practicum in which the whole course is applied to a single extended case. Week 16 consolidates for examination. Each week is one lecture unit of about four notional hours — roughly ninety minutes of scheduled teaching, ninety minutes of seminar or practical work, and the remainder your own reading and writing. Each week has the same shape, and the shape is deliberate: outcomes you can be examined on;

the place of the week in the argument; four key concepts each tied to something a counsellor does in a room; three lectures built from propositions rather than narrative; at least one diagram placed where the argument needs one; worked examples; a practical with a debrief; seminar questions; the assessed task and its criteria; the reading, with the core text marked; and one sentence of synthesis.

A note on the child

The material is addressed throughout to work with children and adolescents, and that is not a decoration on an adult curriculum. A child cannot free-associate, may lack the vocabulary for a cognitive dispute, does not choose to attend, and is embedded in a family and a school that are themselves part of the problem and part of the solution. Theories built for adults fail in particular, predictable ways in a room with a nine-year-old. One purpose of this course is to teach you to see the failure coming.

Standards observed in this volume

British spelling in the book's own prose; American spelling preserved in quoted titles, journal names and direct quotations. Citations in APA 7th edition; only works actually cited are listed; no quotation, statistic or page number has been invented. All case material is fictitious and labelled as such; photographs generated for teaching are captioned as such; standardised instruments are described and attributed but never reproduced. Diagrams are drawn for this edition. The file is a tagged PDF conforming to PDF/UA-1. The governing specification is *HANDBOOK-STANDARD.md*, held with the series.

How to Use This Book

Read the outcomes first and last. Each week opens with what you will be able to do on completing it, written as capabilities that can be observed and examined. Read them before the week and again after it. If you cannot do what they say, you have not finished the week, however much of it you have read.

Work the examples as you meet them. Worked examples are set apart and are not optional reading. Cover the solution, attempt it, then compare. The distance between your attempt and the printed one is precisely the material the examination tests.

Do the practicals. Every week carries a practical — a timed exercise, a formulation task, a role-play, an observation or an analysis of supplied material — with a debrief. Most of them require another person or a recording of yourself and a clock. The practical is the part of the week most often skipped and the part that most changes practice. A theory you have only read is a theory you cannot use.

Keep the comparison grid. Figure 1.3 in week 1 is a blank grid: five questions down the side, four approaches across the top. Complete one column each time the course meets an approach, in your own words, and by week 15 reproduce the whole grid from memory and defend every cell. The grid is the course. Everything else is commentary on it.

Argue with the lectures. Each lecture ends in a clinical implication and a seminar question. The seminar questions are not rhetorical; write answers to them. Where a lecture states a contested position, the contest is named, and your task is to hold a position and say what would change it.

For the tutor. Each week is one four-hour block: ninety minutes of teaching, ninety minutes of seminar or practical work, the remainder preparation and follow-up. The three lectures are self-contained and may be reordered where a cohort needs the case before the theory. The assessed task printed in each week is the task set, and the criteria printed with it are the criteria used. Substitute local material in the vignette and the practical where a cohort's placements differ, provided the substitute is fictitious and labelled.

For the supervisor. The formulation exercises are yours. The question that converts knowledge into judgement is always the same: *which of the approaches in this week would formulate this case differently, and what would that formulation lead you to do on Tuesday?* A trainee who can state a mechanism of change and then say what would falsify it is ready for supervised caseload. A trainee who can only describe a theory is not.

Conventions

Convention	Meaning
Week *n*	the *n*th lecture week of the sixteen-week course
Lecture I, II, III	the three teaching sequences within a week
Worked example	a fully solved illustration; attempt it before reading the solution
Practical	a timed exercise with a debrief; requires a partner, a recording or supplied material
Hypothetical / fictitious composite	case material invented for teaching; no real client is described
Illustrative image (AI-generated)	a photograph created for this edition; depicts no identifiable person
Jurisdiction-dependent	a legal or reporting duty that must be checked against local law

Figures are numbered by week: Figure 3.2 is the second figure of week 3. Figure captions appear below the figure and table captions above the table. Every figure carries alternative text, and the file is tagged for screen readers.

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The Semester at a Glance

Sixteen weeks, one lecture unit each. Weeks 1–14 teach the course; week 15 integrates it on a single extended case; week 16 prepares the examination. The right-hand column names the assessed work of each week; the criteria for each are printed inside the week.

Week	Title	Principal lineage or task	Assessed
1	Mapping Development	the four questions; methods; ethics; the child in context	Reading response, 600 words
2	Foundations Before Birth	genes, teratogens, epigenetics, early adversity	Teratogen case analysis
3	The Constructing Child	Piaget: sensorimotor and preoperational thought	Conservation demonstration log
4	The Social Mind	Vygotsky: ZPD, scaffolding, private speech	Scaffolding exercise
5	Processing and Executive Function	attention, working memory, theory of mind	False-belief critique, 800 words
6	Temperament, Attachment, Regulation	goodness of fit; emotion regulation	Goodness-of-fit analysis
7	Language and Communication	milestones, bilingualism, red flags	Language sample analysis
8	Self, Identity, Morality	Erikson, Kohlberg, Gilligan, conscience	Moral reasoning interview
9	Peers, Play and Gender	Parten, friendship, gender theories	Play observation record
10	Family, Culture, Adversity, Resilience	parenting styles, ACEs, ordinary magic	Adversity and resilience map

Week	Title	Principal lineage or task	Assessed
11	Atypical Development I	neurodevelopmental presentations, developmentally read	Developmental timeline case
12	Atypical Development II	developmental psychopathology: equifinality, transaction	Equifinality essay, 1,200 words
13	Integration	the developing child in the counselling room	Formulation portfolio
14	Observation, Screening, Measurement	tools, cultural fairness, outcome measurement	Screening critique
15	The Practicum: Three Ages	case conference across toddler, school-age, adolescent	Practicum presentation
16	Revision and Examination	consolidation, past questions, examination technique	Final examination

Notional hours. 1.6 units ≈ 24 notional learning hours across the sixteen weeks, of which roughly one third is scheduled teaching and two thirds your own preparation, observation and writing. Weeks vary: the practicum week is heavier in supervised work, the revision week lighter in teaching.

Reading load. Each week marks one core text among its six readings. Read the core text before the week's teaching and the remainder across the week. The core texts of the course are Berk's *Child Development*, Santrock's *Child Development*, and Shonkoff and Phillips's *From Neurons to Neighborhoods*.

Child Development Theories

SEMESTER	UNITS	CATEGORY
First	1.6	Core

Every counsellor of children carries a theory of development, whether or not it has been examined. It is in the sentence "he should have grown out of it by now", in the worry "she is not like the others", in the quiet judgement on a mother. This course puts those theories on the table, names them, tests them against evidence, and hands you back a set of instruments for watching a child develop — and for noticing, early and accurately, when development has left its ordinary course.

Child development is not one theory but a conversation among several: the maturational and the learning accounts; Piaget's constructing child and Vygotsky's social mind; the information-processing account with its bottlenecks; the attachment and temperament account with its transactions; the linguistic, the moral, the ecological; and, over all of them, the principles of developmental psychopathology that tell us how ordinary variation shades into clinical concern and back again. The course moves through these in sixteen weeks, and it never lets you forget the fourth question of week 1: what does this mean for the child in front of you on Thursday?

Two commitments govern the volume. The first is to evidence and to its limits: where a finding comes from a narrow sample, you will be told; where a classic claim has been revised, you will meet the revision; where the honest answer is "we do not know", the book will say so rather than decorate. The second is to context: the children of this programme grow up in compounds and classrooms, markets and churches, in several languages and in economies that tax their parents' patience. A development science that cannot speak to that world is not the science this course teaches.

A fictitious family — Ife, three years and eight months, and her brother Kunle, seven — accompanies the course from week 1 to week 15, so that each theory meets the same children and you can watch the theories disagree about them.

1 LECTURE UNIT 1 Teaching week 1 4 notional hours

Mapping Development: Questions, Methods, and the Child in Context

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **State the four questions** of developmental science — what develops, by what processes, with what universality and variation, and to what purpose for the child in front of you — and place any theory on that map.
2. **Compare** longitudinal, cross-sectional and sequential designs, naming what each can and cannot establish about change.
3. **Choose** a method of studying a child — observation, informant report, self-report, task — appropriate to the child's age and the question asked, stating its bias.
4. **Apply** the ecological model to one child, locating factors at micro, meso, exo and macro levels and in time.
5. **Conduct** research and observation with children ethically: consent and assent, power, and the return of findings to families.

Where this week sits

Volume 1 asked what a theory is for. This volume asks what develops, and how we could possibly know. Child development theory is not a museum of famous names; it is a set of answers to four questions, each answer carrying a method and a method carrying a bias. Every week that follows is one lineage's answer; this week builds the frame you will hang them on, and introduces the child who will accompany us all semester.

Key concepts

THE FOUR QUESTIONS

What develops (description and sequence)? By what processes (mechanism: maturation, learning, transaction)? With what universality and variation (which patterns hold across peoples, and which are local)? To what purpose (what does this tell the counsellor in the room)? In the room: the grid on which every theory in this volume is filed.

DEVELOPMENT AS TRANSACTION

The modern consensus: development is neither the unfolding of a programme nor the writing on a blank page, but a continuous transaction between a child who

acts and a context that responds, each changing the other (Sameroff's transactional model, developed in week 12). In the room: the reason "what is wrong with this child?" is always the wrong first question.

SENSITIVE PERIOD
A window in which an experience organises a system far more powerfully than it later can — language phonology, vision, attachment. Not a door that locks, but a gradient of cost. In the room: the difference between urgency and panic when a child presents late.

ECOLOGICAL MODEL
Bronfenbrenner's nested contexts: microsystem (family, class, peers), mesosystem (the links between them), exosystem (settings the child never enters but which reach the child: a parent's workplace, a school board's decision), macrosystem (culture, law, economy, belief), and chronosystem (time). In the room: the checklist that stops a formulation being a portrait of a child with the world airbrushed out.

Lecture I — The four questions and the child who carries them

Proposition 1. Description precedes explanation, and description is harder than it looks. Before any theory, someone had to watch: to notice that most children walk between nine and eighteen months, that a three-year-old explains rain as the sky crying, that a seven-year-old can hold a rule in mind and a four-year-old mostly cannot. Norms are descriptions with distributions, not deadlines; the counsellor who treats a norm as a deadline pathologises the tails of every curve.

Proposition 2. Mechanism is where theories actually differ. Maturation accounts (development as ripening), learning accounts (development as accumulated experience), and transactional accounts (development as a child–context loop) make different predictions about what an intervention can change and how fast. When two therapists argue about a child, they are usually arguing about mechanism while believing they are arguing about the child.

Proposition 3. Universality is a finding, not an assumption. Some sequences hold wherever anyone has looked — sitting before walking, babbling before words, desire-psychology before belief-psychology. Others, including several celebrated "stages", shift with schooling, language and the practices of a culture. The discipline of this volume: for every pattern, ask where it was found, in whom, and whether it has been found elsewhere.

Proposition 4. Purpose governs method. We study development in order to help particular children, and every method has a price: the laboratory gains precision and loses the child's Tuesday; the home observation gains the Tuesday

and loses control; the parent report gains history and loses the present; the child's own report gains the inside and loses the outside. Method choice is therefore an ethical act, not a technical one.

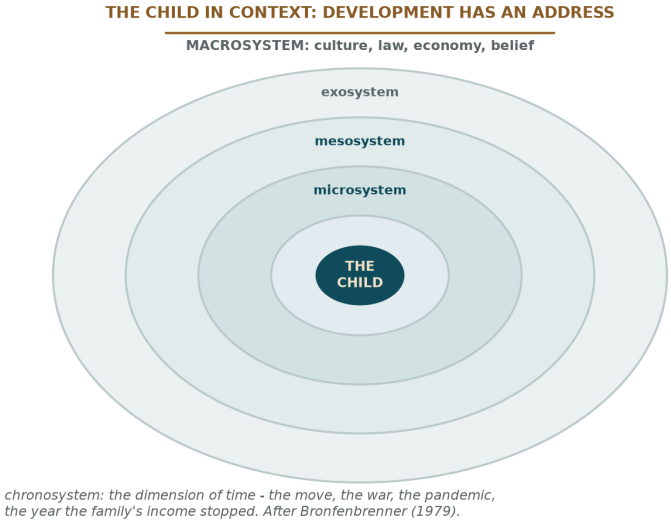


Figure 1.1 Bronfenbrenner's nested ecological systems: microsystem, mesosystem, exosystem and macrosystem around the child, with the chronosystem as the dimension of time. After Bronfenbrenner (1979). *Source:* prepared for this edition.

> **PRACTICE NOTE**
> **Clinical implication.** Begin every case with five minutes of ecology before five minutes of child: who is in the microsystem, which links are working and which are broken, which exosystem decision landed on this family this month, which macrosystem belief is naming this child's difficulty, and what changed in time. The child's symptoms sit inside that map, never outside it.

The running case of this volume

Ife and Kunle — a fictitious composite. Ife is three years and eight months old. She speaks in three- and four-word sentences, insists on the same cup, hides behind her mother's wrapper when strangers greet her, and at nursery settles only after twenty minutes of watching from the doorway. Her brother Kunle is seven: quiet in class, quick at figures, called "proud" by his teacher because he does not ask for help. Their mother trades in the market six days a week; their father drives a commercial bus on night routes; their grandmother lives in the same compound and holds the household together. No real family is described here; every detail is invented for teaching, and the details will accumulate week by week as each theory meets them.

Lecture II — Methods: how we could possibly know

Longitudinal designs follow the same children over time and can describe change within a child — the only design that can. Their prices are time, cost, attrition (the families who leave are not a random sample), and practice effects. **Cross-sectional** designs compare ages at one moment: cheap and fast, but they compare cohorts, not development; a difference between today's eight-year-olds and today's twelve-year-olds may be development or may be four years of history, schooling reform, or a pandemic. **Sequential** designs combine both and can separate age, cohort and time — the design behind the best modern claims, and the reason to read a "age effect" carefully.

Observation, naturalistic or structured, is the royal road of early development: the Strange Situation (week 6) is a structured observation, and your own practicum records will be naturalistic ones. Observation's bias is the observer: we see what our coding scheme permits, and children behave differently when watched — least of all when the watcher is a stranger with a clipboard.

Informant reports (parents, teachers) buy history and context and sell the present: parents are excellent historians of their child and poor calibrated instruments, and teacher reports are framed by class size and by what a teacher has been taught to worry about. **Child self-report** becomes possible in degrees: a four-year-old can report now, an eight-year-old can report yesterday, an adolescent can report a pattern — and each degree has a method that respects it.

Tasks and experiments isolate mechanism: the false-belief task (week 5), the conservation task (week 3), the scaffolded teaching session (week 4). Their bias is the strange adult and the strange room, which depress exactly the competences the task measures.

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> Research and observation with children carry obligations heavier than with adults: consent from the guardian **and** assent from the child in words the child owns; the child's right to stop, honoured the moment it is signalled, not the moment it is spoken; findings returned to the family in usable form, because a family that lent you their child is owed more than a publication; and special care where the observer is also the counsellor, because a child cannot decline the person who holds their secrets.

Worked example 1.1 — Choosing a design, paying its price

Task. A college asks: "does attending our crèche from age two make children's language faster at four?" Propose a design, name what it can establish, and name the confound that will be blamed for whatever you find.

Solution. A cross-sectional comparison of crèche attendees and non-attendees at four confounds attendance with everything that predicts attendance: mothers who enrol a two-year-old differ in education, income, language exposure and

anxiety from mothers who do not, and those differences, not the crèche, will explain the gap in either direction. A longitudinal study from age two, measuring language at two before attendance diverges, and again at three and four, establishes sequence and controls the starting point, but attrition will remove precisely the most chaotic households, inflating every estimate. The strongest feasible design is sequential: two intake cohorts followed with the same measures, which separates cohort from age. The confound that will be blamed regardless: family language environment, which is why any honest report measures conversational turns at home (week 7) and states its limits in the first paragraph, not the last.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 1 — two ways of seeing. In pairs at the college observation nursery (or from a supplied recording): ten minutes of **narrative record** of one child — everything, in order, without interpretation — followed by ten minutes of **checklist record** of the same child using a supplied twelve-item list. Compare: what the narrative caught that the checklist could not; what the checklist caught that the narrative buried; and which record you would defend in a case conference. Write 300 words on the difference and keep both records: they return in week 14.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A reading response of 600 words: choose one claim in this week's core text about what is universal in early development, state where and in whom it was established, and argue whether it should travel to the children you will counsel.

Criterion	Weight
The claim stated precisely, with its evidence base	30%
Universality versus variation argued, not asserted	40%
Consequence for practice stated	30%

Formative. Submit your two observation records with the 300-word comparison.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. Developmental science answers four questions — what develops, by what process, with what universality, to what purpose — using methods whose biases must be named before their findings are believed; and it locates every child in nested contexts and in time, because development has an address.

READING (APA 7TH)

- Berk, L. E. (2013). *Child development* (9th ed.). Pearson. — **core text**; the methods chapter.

- Black, M. M., Walker, S. P., Fernald, L. C. H., Andersen, C. T., DiGirolamo, A. M., Lu, C., McCoy, D., Fink, G., Shawar, Y. R., Shiffman, J., Devercelli, A. E., Trudel, M. T., Wodon, Q., & Grantham-McGregor, S. (2017). Early childhood development coming of age: Science through the life course. *The Lancet, 389*(10064), 77–90.
- Bronfenbrenner, U. (1979). *The ecology of human development: Experiments by nature and design*. Harvard University Press.
- Santrock, J. W. (2019). *Child development* (15th ed.). McGraw-Hill Education. — **core text**; read its life-span perspective chapter against Berk's.
- Shonkoff, J. P., & Phillips, D. A. (Eds.). (2000). *From neurons to neighborhoods: The science of early childhood development*. National Academy Press.
- Sameroff, A. J. (2009). The transactional model. In A. J. Sameroff (Ed.), *The transactional model of development: How children and contexts shape each other* (pp. 3–21). American Psychological Association.

Seminar questions

1. A norm is a description with a distribution. What harm follows when it is taught as a deadline, and to whom?
2. Which of this week's methods would you trust least for a child like Ife, and why?
3. Name one exosystem decision that reached your own childhood before you could name it. What did it change?
4. Why is assent from a child ethically distinct from consent by a guardian? Give the moment in a session where the distinction bites.
5. If a pattern has only ever been found in schooled, urban, Western children, what is its status? A hypothesis, a fact, or a local custom?

Next week

Week 2 goes before birth: genes, teratogens and the windows of sensitivity, epigenetics, and the early adversity that sets a trajectory — with the counselling ethics of never blaming the mother.

2 LECTURE UNIT 2 Teaching week 2 4 notional hours

Foundations Before Birth: Genes, Teratogens and Early Adversity

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Outline** the germinal, embryonic and fetal periods and the principle that teratogenic risk is a function of timing, dose, genetic susceptibility and combination.
2. **Explain** probabilistic epigenesis: how experience regulates gene expression and why neither "in the genes" nor "in the upbringing" is a complete sentence.
3. **Describe** the developmental consequences of undernutrition, malaria in pregnancy, prematurity and early adversity, and the counsel each implies.
4. **Compute** corrected age for a child born preterm and use it to set fair expectations to at least two years.
5. **Counsel** without blame: hold a teratogen or adversity history with a mother without converting it into her guilt.

Where this week sits

Development begins before anyone meets the child. This week is the counsellor's version of embryology: not a memorised timetable but a set of principles about timing and susceptibility, an honest account of what genes do and do not do, and the public-health realities — undernutrition, malaria, prematurity, adversity — that shape the children this programme will serve. It ends where counselling always begins: with a parent who is afraid it was something they did.

Key concepts

TERATOGEN
An agent that disrupts development before birth. Its effect depends on **timing** (the sensitivity window of the organ then forming), **dose**, the **genotype** of mother and fetus, and **combination** with other agents. In the room: the reason "was it the tablet I took?" rarely has a one-word answer, and the reason the answer must still be sought.

PROBABILISTIC EPIGENESIS
Gottlieb's account: genes are one participant in a developmental system, expressed or not expressed depending on internal and external experience, which they in turn shape. Development is probabilistic, not preformed. In the room: the sentence that ends both genetic fatalism and parental omnipotence.

EXPERIENCE-EXPECTANT AND EXPERIENCE-DEPENDENT
Two kinds of learning the brain is built for: circuits that **expect** species-typical input in a window (patterned light for vision, language sound for phonology, responsive care for stress regulation) and circuits that record **whatever** a particular child meets (this language, this compound, this grandmother's songs). In the room: the distinction between what every child needs and what makes this child theirs.

CORRECTED AGE

For a child born preterm, age counted from the due date rather than the birth date; the fair yardstick for developmental expectations roughly to two years, and beyond that for the most preterm. In the room: the arithmetic that keeps a twenty-month-old ex-premie out of a disability register.

Lecture I — Three periods and the logic of the window

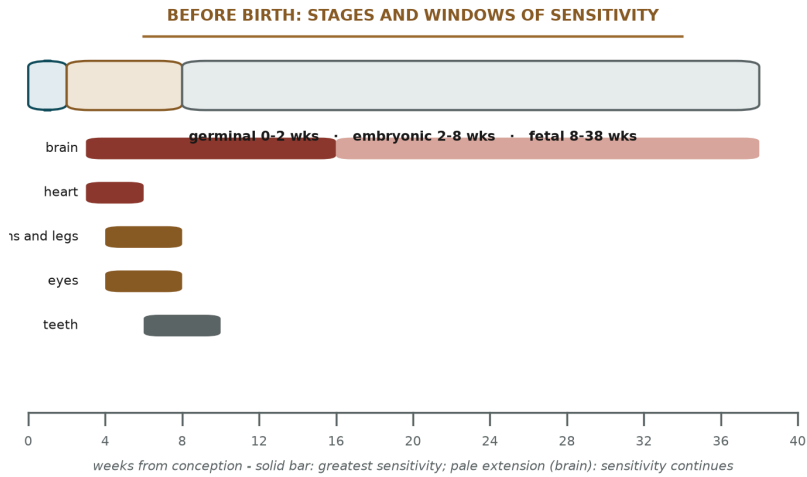


Figure 2.1 Prenatal periods and the sensitivity windows of five organ systems across weeks from conception; the brain's window opens early and stays open, which is why adversity and toxins reach it longest. *Source:* prepared for this edition.

Proposition 1. Timing is the first principle. The embryonic weeks (roughly two to eight from conception) are when organs lay themselves down and when teratogens do their greatest structural damage; the fetal period is when systems grow and refine, and when agents act on function and growth rather than structure. Figure 2.1 shows the windows: the heart's is brief and early, the brain's opens early and never fully closes — which is why the brain is the organ most reachable by later adversity, and the reason week 10's ACEs literature exists.

Proposition 2. Dose, genotype and combination modify everything. Alcohol has no known safe threshold in pregnancy and produces a spectrum — growth, face, and central nervous system, in combinations and degrees — rather than an all-or-none syndrome; valproate in pregnancy raises the risk of neural-tube defects and later neurodevelopmental difficulty; malaria in pregnancy and maternal undernutrition act through the placenta on growth and on the brain's fuel. And the same exposure in two pregnancies yields two outcomes, because

susceptibility is partly genetic: the honest clinical sentence is "this raises risk; it does not write the sentence".

Proposition 3. Genes are participants, not authors. Probabilistic epigenesis replaces the blueprint metaphor: gene expression is regulated by experience — by care, by nutrition, by stress hormones — from the womb outward. The practical consequence is symmetry: a genetic vulnerability can be softened by environment (week 6's goodness of fit), and an environmental risk can be buffered by relationship (week 10's resilience literature). Neither half of nature–nurture is a complete sentence.

> **PRACTICE NOTE**
> **Clinical implication.** Take a prenatal history on every child, once, calmly, as part of the ordinary map: birth weight and weeks, complications, maternal health and medication, alcohol and other substances, and the household's circumstances in that year. Record it as history, not verdict; and record what is unknown as unknown.

Lecture II — Adversity before and around birth, in our context

Undernutrition and stunting. Maternal undernutrition, anaemia and adolescent pregnancy constrain fetal growth; after birth, stunting in the first two years travels with delayed cognitive and motor development at group level, and the mechanism is transactional: a child with less energy explores less, is responded to less, and receives less of the experience-dependent input the brain expects. The counsel is not despair but sequence: nutrition and responsive care together, because either alone underdelivers (the Lancet early-childhood series).

Malaria, infection and inflammation. Malaria in pregnancy contributes to low birth weight; severe early infection and its inflammation reach the developing brain. Public-health measures — nets, intermittent preventive treatment in pregnancy, prompt care — are developmental interventions, and the counsellor who knows this advocates differently.

Prematurity. The preterm infant's brain completes its most vulnerable growth outside the womb, in a world of light, sound and handling it did not expect. Outcomes range from entirely typical to significant disability, and the predictors are weeks at birth, complications, and — again — the environment after discharge. Corrected age is the fair yardstick: a child born at thirty-two weeks is, at four months of age, developmentally expected to behave like a two-month-old, and the expectation should be corrected roughly to two years, longer for the most preterm.

Early adversity and care. Institutional care without a stable responsive adult alters stress regulation, attachment and cognitive trajectories, and the earlier the stable care arrives the better the recovery — the strongest natural experiment in

the whole of developmental science, and the argument behind every foster and adoption standard. Family poverty acts not mainly through want of things but through want of dependable, unhurried, responsive care: stress taxes the caregiver, and the caregiver is the child's environment.

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> A prenatal history includes matters that are, in some places, crimes or sins: alcohol use, undisclosed medication, an unwanted pregnancy. The counsellor's frame is protective, not prosecutorial: information given in a session is used to help the child and to support the mother, and where a current pregnancy is at risk the duty is to the unborn child's care, discharged through support and referral, never through blame. Blame is not only unkind; it is ineffective — it is the single most reliable way to ensure the next mother tells you nothing.

Worked example 2.1 — The question every counsellor dreads

Task. A mother of a four-year-old with language and attention difficulties asks, crying: "Was it the malaria tablets in my first pregnancy? It was my fault." Respond in the register this volume requires: accurate about mechanism, honest about uncertainty, and protective of the relationship.

Solution. Three moves, in order. First, the relationship: "You have carried that question for four years. Thank you for trusting me with it." Second, the mechanism, honestly: intermittent preventive treatment in pregnancy is given **because** malaria itself damages the pregnancy; the medicines used in national programmes are chosen for safety in pregnancy, and no one can attribute an individual child's difficulties to a tablet taken years ago — the honest answer to "was it the tablets?" is "we cannot know, and the evidence does not point that way". Third, the turn to the usable: what is known is this child, now — her language sample (week 7), her attention in play (week 5), the interactions that will move her from here (weeks 4 and 6). The sentence that closes: "Whatever began it, what helps it now is in this room, and most of it is you." Blame is refused not by reassurance but by redirection to mechanism and to work.

Worked example 2.2 — Corrected age, worked

Task. Tobi was born at thirty-two weeks' gestation and is now twenty months old by the calendar. His nursery compares him with the twenty-month group and proposes a "developmental delay" note. Compute and counsel.

Solution. Thirty-two weeks is eight weeks early; corrected age is twenty minus eight, or twelve months. Against twelve-month expectations — first words emerging, pulling to stand, joint attention well established — Tobi's reported skills (walking with a held hand, four words, pointing) are within the ordinary range of his corrected age, and the "delay" is an arithmetic artefact. The counsel

to the nursery: record corrected age beside chronological age on every review to at least two years; compare him with twelve-month expectations; and watch, because ex-preterm children remain a group worth monitoring for attention, learning and growth — monitoring, not labelling. The counsel to the parents: the number that matters this year is not the calendar but the due date he never got.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 2 — the non-blaming history. In threes: mother, counsellor, observer. The counsellor takes a full prenatal and birth history from a "mother" who carries one hidden fear (supplied on a card: alcohol, a tablet, a fall, a wished-for termination). Requirements: ask every necessary question including the feared one; use the three moves of worked example 2.1 when the fear surfaces; end with the turn to the usable. The observer records one sentence: the moment blame was refused or the moment it was accepted. Rotate twice.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A teratogen and adversity case analysis of 900 words: for a supplied case (preterm birth, maternal anaemia, an unverified exposure fear), state the timing logic, the modifiable factors, the corrected-age computation, and the counselling sequence with the caregiver.

Criterion	Weight
Timing, dose, genotype and combination correctly applied	25%
Corrected age computed and used for expectations	20%
Adversity framed transactionally, not fatally	25%
Counselling sequence non-blaming and specific	30%

Formative. Write the one sentence you would say to a mother who believes her child's difficulty is her punishment.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. Before birth, timing governs risk and experience governs expression: teratogens act in windows, genes act as participants in a probabilistic system, and adversity acts mostly through the caregiver — so the counsellor takes a calm prenatal history, corrects the age of the preterm, and refuses blame while turning to what can now be done.

READING (APA 7TH)

- Berk, L. E. (2013). *Child development* (9th ed.). Pearson. — **core text**; the prenatal chapter.

- Gottlieb, G. (2007). Probabilistic epigenesis. *Developmental Science, 10*(1), 1–11.
- Grantham-McGregor, S., Cheung, Y. B., Cueto, S., Glewwe, P., Richter, L., & Strupp, B. (2007). Developmental potential in the first 5 years for children in developing countries. *The Lancet, 369*(9557), 60–70.
- Rutter, M. (2006). *Genes and behavior: Nature–nurture interplay explained*. Blackwell.
- Shonkoff, J. P., & Phillips, D. A. (Eds.). (2000). *From neurons to neighborhoods: The science of early childhood development*. National Academy Press. — **core text**; the prenatal and early adversity chapters.
- Walker, S. P., Wachs, T. D., Gardner, J. M., Lozoff, B., Wasserman, G. A., Pollitt, E., Carter, J. A., & International Child Development Steering Group. (2007). Child development: Risk factors for adverse outcomes in developing countries. *The Lancet, 369*(9556), 145–157.

Seminar questions

1. Why does the brain's sensitivity window make early adversity more consequential than adversity at nine — and what does "more consequential" not mean?
2. Corrected age protects a child from a label. What protects the same child from the label's opposite, the missed referral?
3. "Genes load the gun, environment pulls the trigger" is popular and wrong. Where exactly does the metaphor fail?
4. What in your own culture names a child's difficulty as the mother's sin, and how will you counsel inside that belief without endorsing it?
5. If probabilistic epigenesis is true, what does a prognosis actually claim?

Next week

Week 3 meets the most famous answer to "what develops": Piaget's constructing child, from the baby who finds the hidden rattle to the seven-year-old who finally sees that the water is the same.

3 LECTURE UNIT 3 Teaching week 3 4 notional hours

The Constructing Child: Piaget from Rattle to Reversibility

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Explain** Piaget's mechanism — schema, assimilation, accommodation, equilibration — and why it makes the child an active constructor rather than a recipient.
2. **Describe** the sensorimotor and preoperational achievements and limits: object permanence and the A-not-B error, symbolic and pretend play, egocentrism, centration, animism, conservation failure.
3. **Administer and interpret** two conservation tasks and one class-inclusion task, recording the child's reasoning rather than only the verdict.
4. **State** the modern critiques — competence versus performance, horizontal décalage, cultural and schooling effects, Siegler's overlapping waves — and what survives them.
5. **Use** the stage account in counselling: matching explanation, task and play to the child's current construction of the world.

Where this week sits

Piaget changed the question from "how much does the child know?" to "how does the child's knowing work?" His stages are now taught with their corrections attached, but the corrections only sharpen his central claim: children do not think less than adults, they think **differently**, coherently, by rules of their own. For the counsellor this is liberation: the child who says the sky is crying is not wrong, they are operating a system — and a counselling method that ignores the system will talk past the child all session.

Key concepts

EQUILIBRATION
Piaget's engine: the child assimilates experience into existing schemas until the mismatch forces accommodation, and the cycle of the two — equilibration — is development itself. In the room: why a child's "wrong" answer is data about their current system, and why contradiction, gently held, is the teaching moment.

OBJECT PERMANENCE
The discovery that things exist unseen, built across the sensorimotor years and visible in its failures: the A-not-B error, where the infant who found the toy at A reaches to A again after seeing it hidden at B — knowing and acting not yet reconciled. In the room: the infant separation game: out of sight is not yet fully out of existence, and by twelve months it very much is.

CENTRATION AND CONSERVATION
The preoperational child centres on one salient dimension — the height of the glass — and therefore judges the poured water to be more; conservation is the discovery

that quantity survives transformation, and it arrives dimension by dimension, not all at once. In the room: the reason a five-year-old's grief at the "smaller" cake is logic, not manipulation.

HORIZONTAL DECALAGE
The unevenness within a stage: a child reasons at one level with familiar material and a level below with strange material, conserving number before volume and volume before weight. In the room: the reason stage labels should be used as adjectives, never as nouns, about a child.

Lecture I — The staircase and what each step can hold

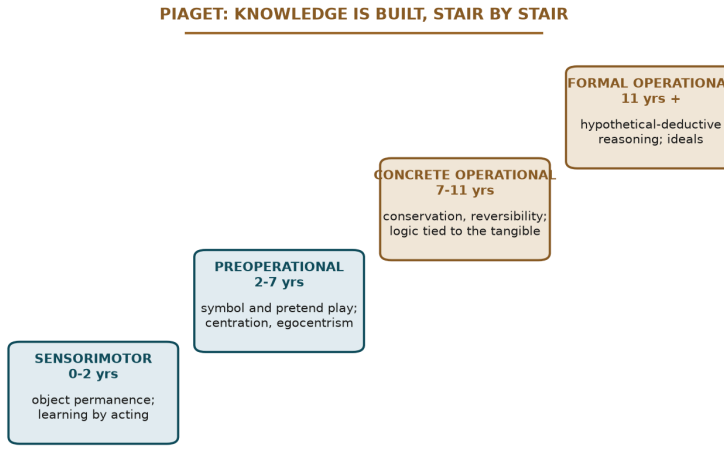


Figure 3.1 Piaget's four stages as a staircase with ages and signature achievements: object permanence, symbol and pretend play, conservation and reversibility, hypothetical-deductive reasoning; with the caveat of horizontal décalage. *Source:* prepared for this edition.

Proposition 1. The sensorimotor child knows by acting. From reflex to intention, from circular reactions to the first mental representation: the infant who pulls a cloth to reach a rattle upon it has invented means–ends; the infant who searches for the hidden rattle has invented existence. Pretend play appears at the top of this stair — the child who feeds a doll is operating a symbol, and symbol is the currency of every later therapy hour.

Proposition 2. The preoperational child represents but centres. Language explodes, play becomes sociodramatic, and the world is organised by perception and by the child's own position: egocentrism is not selfishness but the genuine difficulty of computing another viewpoint (the three-mountains

task), and centration makes quantity hostage to appearance. Animism — the sun follows me because it wants to — is the same system applied to causality. These are coherent rules, and a counsellor who knows them hears a four-year-old's guilt after a parent's death ("I was angry at her") as developmental logic requiring careful release, not as pathology.

Proposition 3. Concrete operations are reversible operations. Conservation, class inclusion, seriation: the child can now run a transformation backwards in mind and hold two dimensions at once — but tied to the tangible and the present. Formal operations add the hypothetical: the adolescent who reasons about justice, about the future, about who they might be — and who can therefore be counselled with hypothesis-testing (volume 1, week 6) in a way the eight-year-old cannot.

> **PRACTICE NOTE**
> **Clinical implication.** Match the method to the stair: with the preoperational child, play, draw and enact rather than talk about; externalise in objects (volume 1, week 11) because objects are their grammar; with the concrete-operational child, use tangible scales, cards and charts; reserve pure verbal insight work for formal operations, and even then check the stair under stress, because anxiety drops every child a step.

Lecture II — What the critiques changed, and what survived

Competence versus performance. Simplified tasks show abilities Piaget dated later: infants violate-of-expectation paradigms look like object knowledge in the first year; three-year-olds pass false-belief tasks in some cultures and versions years before the classic schedule (week 5). Piaget's stages are therefore best read as the ages at which competences become **reliable in standard tasks**, not the ages at which they appear.

Horizontal décalage and overlapping waves. Conservation arrives dimension by dimension; and Siegler showed that at any age a child holds several strategies at once, choosing among them by cost and success — development as changing mixtures, not replacing stages. The staircase survives as a map of dominant strategies, not as a lift with locked floors.

Culture and schooling. Conservation and class-inclusion performance shifts with schooling and with the practices of a community; some cultures' children pass certain tasks earlier and others later, and formal-operational reasoning is exercised where the culture exercises it. Piaget universalised the schoolchild; the correction is week 1's fourth question, applied.

What survived. Constructivism; the active child; the sequence of sensorimotor achievements; the qualitative difference of preoperational thought; the clinical interview as a method — Piaget's greatest gift to counselling, the habit of asking

"how did you know?" and listening to the reasoning rather than scoring the answer.

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> Stage knowledge cuts both ways in safeguarding: a child's concrete-operational logic means a nine-year-old may genuinely not generalise a safety rule to a new setting ("stranger" meant the man in the car, not the neighbour), so safety teaching must be rehearsed across settings rather than stated once; and a child's preoperational egocentrism means they may believe their anger caused a death or a divorce, so every bereavement and separation conversation with a child under seven includes the explicit, repeated release of that belief.

Worked example 3.1 — Conservation with Ife, recorded properly

Task. Ife (3 years 8 months) is given two identical beakers of equal juice and agrees they are "the same". One is poured into a tall thin glass. Record and interpret.

Solution. Ife points to the tall glass: "that one plenty." Asked how she knows: "look! e long." The record must keep her words and her reason — centration on height, justification by perception — and must also record the counter-suggestion test: when the juice is poured back and she again says "same", the interpretation is stable preoperational centration, not confusion or compliance. Two cautions for the record: first, the question "which has more?" can be heard by a young child as "which did I make you change?", so a third-party puppet who "thinks they're the same" is introduced and Ife's disagreement with the puppet noted — the difference between a logical judgement and a social guess. Second, the verdict is not "Ife fails conservation"; it is "Ife, at 3:8, centres on height with familiar material, justifies by perception, and is stable across transformations" — a description that will be comparable with the same tasks at five and at seven.

Worked example 3.2 — When the stage is the intervention

Task. Kunle (7) will not begin written work he might not finish perfectly; he tears the page. His teacher calls it pride. Design the counsellor's response using this week's theory.

Solution. Kunle is at the concrete-operational threshold: he can reverse operations in mind — which is exactly the trap, because he can now imagine the finished page and compare it with the present one, and the mismatch is intolerable. The intervention is staged, not verbal: (i) externalise the standard into an object — a "first-draft box" into which imperfect pages go by rule, making imperfection a location rather than a verdict; (ii) use reversibility as the medicine — show the torn page restored by tape and the page rewritten, and have Kunle order photographs of a page from bad to good to see that states are transformations, not identities; (iii) give the teacher the décalage sentence: Kunle's reasoning about numbers

runs a step ahead of his reasoning about his own work, so praise his number logic openly and his drafts by rule, never by adjective. "Pride" dissolves into a developmental task: the discovery that a page, like water, remains a page through transformation.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 3 — the clinical interview, Piaget's method. In pairs with a supplied child (or recording): administer number conservation, liquid conservation and a class-inclusion question ("In this box there are eight roses and two daisies; are there more roses or more flowers?"). Record verbatim the child's justifications. Then write 250 words: the child's dominant strategy, the evidence of décalage if any, and one sentence of what you would teach next and why. The mark is for the recording of reasoning, not the verdicts.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A conservation demonstration log: your two recorded tasks with justifications, plus 500 words placing the child on the staircase with evidence, naming one critique that limits your inference and how you honoured it.

Criterion	Weight
Tasks administered cleanly, third-party control used	25%
Child's reasoning recorded verbatim and interpreted as strategy	35%
Stage placement argued with décalage in view	20%
Critique named and its limit honoured	20%

Formative. One paragraph: the preoperational sentence a child once said to you (or in this week's recording) that is logic, not error — and the rule it obeys.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. Piaget's child constructs the world by acting on it, through schemas that assimilate until they must accommodate; the staircase from rattle to reversibility remains the best map of dominant strategies, read with décalage, culture and overlapping waves in view — and its clinical gift is the interview that listens for the child's reasoning, because counselling that ignores the child's system talks past the child.

READING (APA 7TH)

- Berk, L. E. (2013). *Child development* (9th ed.). Pearson. — **core text**; the cognitive-development chapters.

- Piaget, J. (1952). *The origins of intelligence in children*. International Universities Press.
- Piaget, J., & Inhelder, B. (1969). *The psychology of the child*. Basic Books.
- Santrock, J. W. (2019). *Child development* (15th ed.). McGraw-Hill Education.
- Siegler, R. S. (1996). *Emerging minds: The process of change in children's development*. Oxford University Press.

Seminar questions

1. A child says the poured glass has more, then pours it back and says "same again". Is this inconsistency? What would consistency even mean in an overlapping-waves account?
2. Which of Piaget's claims would you defend most strongly today, and which would you retire? Give evidence for each choice.
3. Why does egocentrism make bereavement work with the under-sevens a matter of explicit sentence-making?
4. If formal operations are exercised only where a culture exercises them, what should a secondary curriculum owe every student?
5. Play is Piaget's symbol made visible. What does that make the playroom, epistemologically?

Next week

Week 4 crosses to the other great answer: Vygotsky's social mind, the zone of proximal development, and scaffolding — the theory that makes the teacher, the parent and the counsellor part of the child's cognition rather than spectators of it.

4 LECTURE UNIT 4 Teaching week 4 4 notional hours

The Social Mind: Vygotsky, the Zone and the Scaffold

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Contrast** Vygotsky's social origin of mind with Piaget's individual construction, stating what each explains that the other cannot.
2. **Define** the zone of proximal development and distinguish dynamic from static assessment, stating what each predicts.
3. **Demonstrate** scaffolding with its six moves — recruiting, reducing degrees of freedom, direction maintenance, marking critical features, frustration control, demonstration — and its withdrawal.
4. **Interpret** private speech developmentally, as a tool rather than a fault, and counsel a teacher or parent who hears it as one.

5. **Apply** the zone to emotional and social learning: the scaffolded regulation of a child who cannot yet regulate alone.

Where this week sits

Piaget watched the child alone with the world; Vygotsky watched the child with someone. The difference is not academic: it decides whether the counsellor sees a score or a trajectory, a deficit or an untaught zone. This week installs the most practically powerful idea in the volume — that what a child can do with help today, they can do alone tomorrow, and that help has a grammar — and carries it from homework to heartbreak.

Key concepts

ZONE OF PROXIMAL DEVELOPMENT

The distance between what the child does independently and what they do with a capable partner; the region where teaching lands. In the room: the reason a static test measures yesterday and a scaffolded session measures tomorrow — and the region every intervention should be aimed at.

SCAFFOLDING

The contingent support a partner provides inside the zone — recruiting interest, simplifying, holding the goal, marking what matters, controlling frustration, demonstrating — handed over step by step and withdrawn step by step (Wood, Bruner & Ross). In the room: the grammar of help; support that never fades is not scaffolding, it is substitution.

PRIVATE SPEECH

The child's speech to self: for Piaget, egocentric residue to be outgrown; for Vygotsky, thought in the making — social speech turned inward, audible at first, whispered later, silent finally. In the room: the child muttering through a hard task is not disturbing the class; they are regulating it.

DYNAMIC ASSESSMENT

Test, teach, retest: the measure of the zone rather than of the stock. Its score is the amount and kind of help that moved the child, and it predicts learning better than a static score in several populations, including children whose language or culture the static test does not speak. In the room: the antidote to the label that a single morning's testing can otherwise write on a child.

Lecture I — Mind begins between people

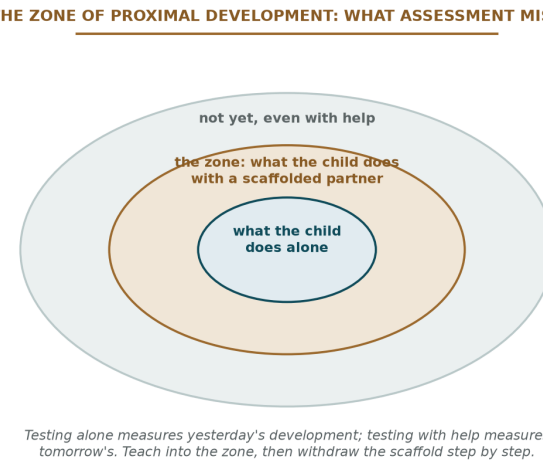


Figure 4.1 The zone of proximal development as three regions: what the child does alone, what the child does with a scaffolded partner, and what is not yet reachable even with help; with the counsel to test with help as well as alone. *Source:* prepared for this edition.

Proposition 1. Every function appears twice. First between people, on the social plane; then within the child, on the psychological plane. Attention is first jointly held ("look!"), memory is first stored in a parent's narrative ("remember when..."), regulation is first co-regulation (week 6). The child's inner tools are internalised conversations — which is why the quality of the conversations a child is given is the quality of the mind they build.

Proposition 2. Tools shape thought. Language is the master tool, but cultures hand children others: counting systems, scripts, calendars, proverbs, prayer. A child's reasoning carries the marks of its tools; the counsellor who forgets this mistakes a tool difference for a capacity difference, which is week 1′s universality question with consequences.

Proposition 3. The zone is where development happens, and it is invisible to static testing. A test administered alone scores the achieved; two children with the same achieved score can have entirely different zones, and it is the zone that predicts what the next term of teaching — or therapy — will produce. Dynamic assessment makes the zone visible by measuring the help: how much prompting, of what kind, before the child crosses.

Proposition 4. Scaffolding has a grammar and a morality. The grammar is contingency: help is given in inverse proportion to competence, marked at the critical features, and faded as competence arrives; the six moves of Wood and colleagues are its verbs. The morality is this: scaffolding aims at its own withdrawal.

Help that persists after competence arrives is not kindness; it is the quiet theft of the child's next step.

> **PRACTICE NOTE**
> **Clinical implication.** In every session ask the zone question twice: what did this child do today only with me, and what did I do for them today that they could have done with less? The first answer is next week's target; the second is this week's confession.

Lecture II — Private speech, and the teacher who mishears it

Private speech peaks audibly between roughly three and seven, rises with task difficulty, and falls to whisper and then silence as it becomes inner speech. It predicts better task performance, not worse; children with attentional difficulties often use **more** of it, later, because their regulation work is harder. The teacher who hears muttering as disobedience is hearing a tool as a fault.

The counsel to the teacher has three sentences: what the muttering is (the child thinking aloud, exactly as the teacher once did); what it will do (fade by itself as the skill internalises, typically across the primary years); and what to do instead of stopping it (watch whether it rises when the task hardens — that is the child working, and the moment to offer a scaffold rather than a reprimand). For the child with a language difference, private speech may arrive in the home language first: a further reason never to correct it mid-task.

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> Dynamic assessment carries a safeguarding use: where a child's static scores are low and the culture or language of the test is not the child's, a dynamic session can be the difference between a misdiagnosis of intellectual disability and the discovery of an untaught zone. Before any label of global delay is accepted, ask what the child did with help that they could not do alone; record both numbers; and insist that the report carry both.

Worked example 4.1 — Scaffolding Kunle's homework, move by move

Task. Kunle (7) must write three sentences about his weekend. He stalls at the blank page, jaw set. Script the scaffold with the six moves, then script its fading next week.

Solution. *Recruiting:* "Tell me the best thing first — the football or the rain?" (interest before task). *Reducing degrees of freedom:* the page is folded into three boxes; one sentence per box; "we only need the football one now." *Direction maintenance:* after the first sentence, "two boxes left; the rain one is next" — the goal held visibly. *Marking critical features:* "your sentence has who and what; lis-

ten: 'Kunle played football.' Who? What? Yours needs the same two." *Frustration control:* "the first sentence is always the worst; everybody's is." *Demonstration:* the counsellor writes one sentence about their own weekend aloud, thinking visibly, including one crossed-out word. Kunle writes two sentences with the fold and one without. *Fading, next week:* the fold becomes a line, the line becomes a page; the who–what prompt becomes a raised eyebrow; the demonstration becomes "show me how you'd start". By week four the scaffold is a question — "what's the best thing?" — and then it is nothing, which was always the plan. The record notes the zone: three sentences with structural support, one alone; next week's target is two alone.

Worked example 4.2 — The zone of feeling

Task. Ife (3:8) melts at nursery drop-off. Using this week's theory, design the regulation scaffold and name what would make it substitution instead.

Solution. Regulation at three is co-regulation (week 6): the zone runs from "dysregulated alone" to "settled with a familiar adult who lends a slow voice and a predictable sequence". The scaffold: a goodbye ritual of exactly three steps (wrapper hug, window wave, cup on shelf), rehearsed at home in play first (the social plane before the psychological); the key worker receives her with the ritual's words, not new ones; the settling time is recorded daily — twenty minutes, then twelve, then six — because the fading is the measure. The withdrawal: the ritual shortens by one step when settling holds under five minutes; then the key worker's presence recedes to the doorway; then the wave is from the gate. Substitution would be: the key worker holding Ife all morning, every day, indefinitely — settling without transfer, comfort without competence, the zone never crossed. The difference between scaffolding and substitution is the record of fading: if the steps are not shrinking month by month, the adult is not a scaffold, they are a crutch the service has grown fond of.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 4 — dynamic versus static. In pairs with a supplied child or recording: administer a static task (e.g., a four-piece pattern completion) and score it; then teach the same task's principle for five minutes using the six scaffold moves and re-administer; record the static score, the amount and kind of help required, and the post-teach score. Write 200 words: which number predicts next month's learning, and what the help profile says that neither score says. Debrief in plenary: whose children are most mis-served by static-only testing in our setting?

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A scaffolding exercise: a recorded ten-minute scaffolded teaching session with a child on a task of your choice, annotated move by move, with a written fading plan for the following three sessions (500 words).

Criterion	Weight
All six moves present and contingent (help inversely matched to competence)	35%
Zone identified: achieved level, assisted level, next target	25%
Fading planned concretely across three sessions	25%
Private speech respected or appropriately harnessed	15%

Formative. Write the three-sentence counsel to a teacher who calls a muttering child disobedient.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. Vygotsky relocates mind into relationship: functions appear first between people, tools shape thought, the zone of proximal development is where teaching lands, scaffolding is the grammar of help with withdrawal as its purpose, and private speech is the sound of a child building regulation — so assessment must measure the help as well as the stock, and every intervention aims at the day it is no longer needed.

READING (APA 7TH)

- Berk, L. E. (2013). *Child development* (9th ed.). Pearson. — **core text**; the Vygotsky chapter, read against its Piaget chapter.
- Rogoff, B. (1990). *Apprenticeship in thinking: Cognitive development in social context*. Oxford University Press.
- Santrock, J. W. (2019). *Child development* (15th ed.). McGraw-Hill Education.
- Vygotsky, L. S. (1978). *Mind in society: The development of higher psychological processes*. Harvard University Press.
- Wood, D., Bruner, J. S., & Ross, G. (1976). The role of tutoring in problem solving. *Journal of Child Psychology and Psychiatry, 17*(2), 89–100.

Seminar questions

1. Two children score identically on a static test; their zones differ by half a year. What does the school owe each, and how would it know?
2. Where is the line between scaffolding and doing the task for the child? Give an observable test, not a feeling.

3. Private speech in the home language: what does a school lose by banning it, in Vygotskian terms?
4. Is co-regulation scaffolding? Use the six moves to argue yes or no.
5. Vygotsky makes the counsellor part of the child's cognition. What does that do to the idea of a "neutral" therapist?

Next week

Week 5 opens the mind as a working system: attention, working memory and the discovery that other people have minds of their own — executive function and theory of mind, with the false-belief task administered and argued over.

5 LECTURE UNIT 5 Teaching week 5 4 notional hours

Processing and Executive Function: The Working Mind and Other Minds

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Outline** the information-processing account: attention, working memory, processing speed and strategy development across childhood.
2. **Describe** the three components of executive function and their developmental trajectory, and state why EF is a better school-readiness predictor than many expect.
3. **Administer and score** a standard false-belief task, and interpret a pass and a fail without over- or under-reading either.
4. **Explain** theory of mind's consequences for counselling: perspective-taking, understanding of lie and secret, and the credibility of a child's testimony.
5. **Recognise** EF demands in ordinary classroom failure, and design one accommodation that lowers demand without lowering expectation.

Where this week sits

Two revolutions meet in this week. The information-processing tradition treats the mind as a working system with bottlenecks — and much of what adults call disobedience is a bottleneck. The theory-of-mind tradition discovers that at around four to five the child grasps that minds **represent** rather than copy the world — the single cognitive event beneath every later empathy, every lie detected, and every therapeutic conversation about what someone else was thinking. Both are measurable, both vary with language and context, and both are routinely mistaken for character.

Key concepts

WORKING MEMORY
Holding and using information in mind over seconds; capacity grows steadily through childhood and is severely limited at any age — which is why a three-step instruction loses its third step somewhere in a six-year-old's hallway. In the room: the cheapest, most missed accommodation in education and in therapy.

EXECUTIVE FUNCTION
The coordinating system: inhibitory control (stopping the prepotent response), working memory, and cognitive flexibility (shifting set). Develops steeply across the preschool and primary years, vulnerable to stress, sleep loss and adversity — and trainable in the ordinary sense that use and scaffolding train it. In the room: the dimension on which "could if he tried" is usually false.

FALSE-BELIEF TASK
The test of representational mind: the child who understands that Sally will look where she **believes** the marble is, not where it is, has grasped that minds can be wrong — the foundation of deception detection, of empathy as cognitive act, and of understanding that the counsellor has a mind too. In the room: the four-to-five watershed, shifted months by language, conversation and siblings.

METACOGNITION
Thinking about one's own thinking: knowing what one knows, monitoring comprehension, choosing a strategy. Emerges visibly in the primary years and is the engine of independent learning — and of the reflective work therapy later asks for. In the room: the reason "think about why you did that" is an impossible instruction at five and a fair one at eleven.

Lecture I — The working system and its bottlenecks

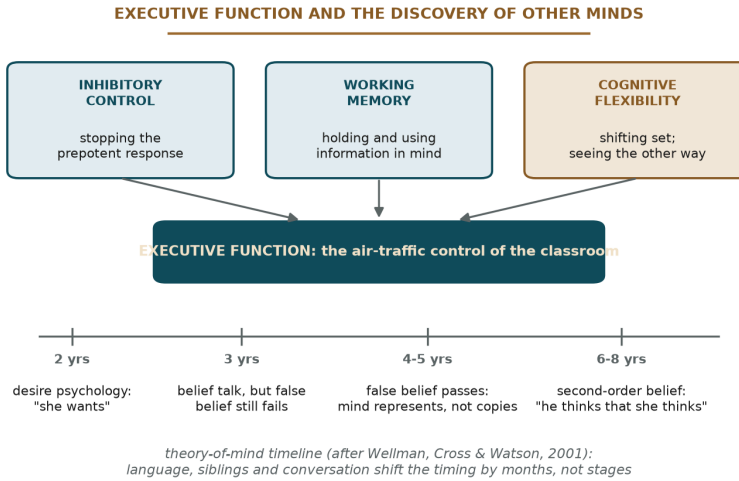


Figure 5.1 The three components of executive function converging on the coordinating system, above a theory-of-mind timeline from desire psychology at two to second-order belief in the primary years; language and conversation shift the timing. After Diamond (2013) and Wellman, Cross and Watson (2001). *Source:* prepared for this edition.

Proposition 1. Much of childhood "misbehaviour" is capacity, not choice. The child who answers before the question ends (inhibition), who loses the third step (working memory), who cannot switch from play to pack-up (shifting) is displaying the ordinary limits of a developing system. The diagnostic habit this week installs: before any moral reading of a failure, ask which component the task demanded and whether the child's system, today, under this stress, has it.

Proposition 2. EF is developmentally honest and socially unequal. EF develops steeply between three and seven and into adolescence; it is depressed by chronic stress, poor sleep and adversity — the mechanisms behind week 10's adversity findings — and it predicts early literacy and numeracy in several cohorts beyond general ability (Diamond, 2013). A classroom that knows this teaches EF in the grain of the day: routines that externalise memory (lists, pictures, songs), games that train stopping and shifting, and transitions announced before they happen.

Proposition 3. Strategy development is the visible face of processing change. Young children do not spontaneously rehearse, organise or elaborate; they must be taught the strategy and then taught **when** to use it — utilisation deficits are the rule. Metacognition follows: the eight-year-old who knows they did not understand the paragraph is operating a monitor the five-year-old lacks.

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. Audit your own instructions this week: count the steps in each thing you ask a child to do. Then halve them, or write them down, or sing them. The accommodation costs nothing and rescues more children than any referral.

Lecture II — The discovery of other minds

Before three, children operate a desire psychology: people act to get what they want. Belief enters slowly; at three, children grasp that minds can be about things, but a mind that is **wrong** still defeats them — in the standard false-belief task they send Sally to the true location. Between four and five, across cultures and tasks, the majority cross: minds represent, representations can be false, and action follows the representation (Wellman, Cross & Watson, 2001). Language, conversations about minds, and siblings shift the timing by months; deaf children of hearing parents, deprived of that conversation, cross late — the cleanest evidence that the discovery is made in dialogue.

Consequences for the counselling room, in four. *Perspective-taking:* before the watershed, "how do you think she felt?" asks a question the child's system cannot yet compute; use enactment and objects instead. *Lie and secret:* a child who understands false belief understands that a speaker can plant a false mind — the cognitive basis of lying, of being lied to, and of keeping a secret someone planted; safeguarding interviews must therefore date themselves against this competence. *Testimony:* a pre-representational child's account is not less honest but differently suggestible — they answer from the world, not from a monitored representation of it, so leading questions rewrite rather than retrieve. *Therapy itself:* every interpretation you offer is a claim about the child's mind held in your mind; the child who cannot yet hold minds-in-minds experiences interpretation as fact or as nonsense, never as hypothesis — one more reason volume 1′s work with the young is play and enactment, not insight.

SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT

Where a child's disclosure is evidence, this week's science is law-adjacent: a child below the representational watershed is highly answerable to leading questions, not because they lie but because their memory is reconstructive and social. Practitioners do not interview such children investigatively; they record what the child says spontaneously, in the child's words, and refer to trained forensic interviewers. The counsellor's room stays the child's room.

Worked example 5.1 — False belief with Ife: protocol, score, caution

Task. Administer a Sally–Anne style task to Ife (3:8) and write the record.

Solution. Protocol: enact with two dolls and a visible transfer; control questions first (where is the marble really? where was it at first?) — a child who fails a control question has failed comprehension, not theory of mind, and the trial is void. Test question: where will Sally look? Ife answers the true location (the basket Anne moved it to). Record: fails false belief with controls passed; desire vocabulary present ("Sally want her ball"); belief talk absent. Interpretation, carefully: this is the expected profile at 3:8 — not a deficit, not a prediction of empathy failure, and not stable: re-test at four-and-a-half with conversation about minds in between, because the watershed is near and language-rich interaction moves it. Caution written into the record: the task was administered in Ife's stronger language; a child tested in a weaker language fails tasks their mind has already passed, which is an assessment error with a child's name on it.

Worked example 5.2 — The classroom failure that is a bottleneck

Task. Kunle (7) "refuses" group work: he dominates or withdraws, and his written instructions lose their endings. Analyse by component and design one accommodation per failure.

Solution. Group work demands simultaneous inhibition (wait your turn), working memory (hold the group's plan while holding your part), and shifting (move between speaker roles) — the full EF triad under social load, which for a seven-year-old with a quiet, slow-to-shift profile is the hardest room in the school. Dominance is inhibition failure under load; withdrawal is the child's own sensible rationing. Accommodations that lower demand without lowering expectation: roles made external and visible (a card that says RECORDER, turned over when the role turns), the group plan written in three boxes rather than held in air, and a two-minute warning before role change so shifting is prepared rather than sprung. For the written instructions: numbered steps on the board remain all lesson — the accommodation is environmental memory, and the expectation (follow all steps) is untouched. Review in four weeks: if dominance and withdrawal persist **with** demand lowered, the question changes from capacity to anxiety or to the ADHD dimension of week 11 — and the record of what was tried is what makes that referral credible.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 5 — the EF audit. Observe (live or recorded) one classroom or nursery session for twenty minutes with a three-column sheet: demand on inhibition / on working memory / on shifting. Record each demand event and each child failure that matches it. Write 250 words: the single demand that produced most failures, and one environmental accommodation for it. Bring the sheet to week 14, where it becomes part of your measurement portfolio.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A false-belief critique of 800 words: administer or observe the task, then critique one popular over-reading (e.g. "fails false belief, therefore cannot empathise" or "passes, therefore can be interviewed investigatively"), using this week's propositions and one empirical caution (language, controls, or timing).

Criterion	Weight
Task protocol correct, including control questions	30%
Over-reading identified and dismantled with mechanism	40%
Empirical caution applied concretely	30%

Formative. One paragraph: an instruction you gave a child this month that their working memory could not hold. Rewrite it.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. The mind works with bottlenecks and with a coordinating system that develops under stress and scaffolding alike; and around four to five the child discovers that minds represent and can be wrong — the watershed beneath empathy, deception, testimony and therapy itself — so the practitioner audits demands before morals, dates every interview against the watershed, and tests in the child's language or not at all.

READING (APA 7TH)

- Berk, L. E. (2013). *Child development* (9th ed.). Pearson. — **core text**; information processing and theory of mind.
- Diamond, A. (2013). Executive functions. *Annual Review of Psychology, 64*, 135–168.
- Flavell, J. H. (1979). Metacognition and cognitive monitoring: A new area of cognitive–developmental inquiry. *American Psychologist, 34*(10), 906–911.
- Gathercole, S. E., & Alloway, T. P. (2008). *Working memory and learning: A practical guide for teachers*. SAGE.
- Wellman, H. M., Cross, D., & Watson, J. (2001). Meta-analysis of theory-of-mind development: The truth about false belief. *Child Development, 72*(3), 655–684.

Seminar questions

1. "He could do it if he tried." Under an EF account, what is this sentence usually hiding, and what would the honest version say?
2. Why does a child who fails false belief answer leading questions differently — and what follows for a safeguarding conversation?

3. A child tested in their weaker language fails. Whose error is recorded on the form, and how should the form say so?
4. Is metacognition trainable, or does it arrive? Use the utilisation-deficit evidence to argue.
5. Which of your own professional routines is an external working-memory device you have stopped noticing?

Next week

Week 6 turns from the cold mind to the warm one: temperament, attachment and the development of emotion regulation — and goodness of fit, the idea that rescues "difficult" children from their diagnoses.

6 LECTURE UNIT 6 Teaching week 6 4 notional hours

Temperament, Attachment and the Regulation of Emotion

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Describe** temperament and its classic dimensions and styles, and state what temperament is not (not destiny, not diagnosis, not character).
2. **Apply** goodness of fit to one case: locating the mismatch between a child's temperament and the demands of their context, and redesigning the context.
3. **Trace** the development of emotion regulation from co-regulation to self-regulation, naming the caregiver behaviours that carry it.
4. **Summarise** attachment's normative course — signals, secure base, internal working models — as developmental science rather than as verdict on mothers.
5. **Counsel** a parent of a "difficult" child: reframe, re-sequence, and protect the relationship that is the child's actual intervention.

Where this week sits

Volume 1 used attachment as clinical theory; this week uses it as development. The question changes from "what category is this dyad?" to "how does a human being acquire the regulation of their own emotion, and what does the environment owe that process?" Between temperament and attachment sits the most humane idea in the volume: goodness of fit — the discovery that a child's difficulty is often a mismatch, and that mismatches are redesignable.

Key concepts

TEMPERAMENT
Constitutionally based individual differences in reactivity and self-regulation, observable early and relatively stable: activity level, rhythmicity, approach–withdrawal, adaptability, threshold, intensity, mood, distractibility, persistence. Classically grouped as easy, difficult and slow-to-warm — descriptions of style, not worth. In the room: the first draft of the person, written in ink that environment can edit but not erase.

GOODNESS OF FIT
Thomas and Chess's principle: outcome depends on the match between the child's temperament and the demands and expectations of their context. The same reactivity is "difficult" in a hurried home and "spirited" in a patient one. In the room: the intervention target that is neither the child nor the parent but the fit between them.

CO-REGULATION
The borrowed regulation of early life: the caregiver's voice, pace, hold and face doing for the child's arousal what the child's own system cannot yet do, until repeated thousands of times it becomes the child's inner function. In the room: why "calm down" is not a strategy at three, and why the adult's own regulation is the child's therapy.

INTERNAL WORKING MODEL
The accumulated expectation of what happens when I signal: built from thousands of episodes of care, carried into new relationships, and revisable — slowly — by later ones. In the room: the mechanism by which early care reaches the counselling hour, and the reason the counselling hour can, in turn, reach forward.

Lecture I — Temperament: the first draft

Proposition 1. Temperament is real, early and editable. Reactivity and regulation differ from the first weeks, are partly heritable, and predict some later outcomes at group level — the inhibited infant is somewhat more likely to be the cautious seven-year-old. But prediction is probabilistic and the editor is environment: reactivity becomes vigour, leadership or volatility depending on what meets it.

Proposition 2. The styles are descriptions of fit-risk, not of children. The "difficult" cluster — intense, withdrawing, irregular — is difficult **to a particular kind of context**: one that values quick settling, regular schedules and low volume. In another context the same child is the one who notices everything

and cannot be rushed into danger. The classic New York Longitudinal Study's own conclusion was not a typology of children but a theory of match.

Proposition 3. Goodness of fit makes the context a treatment variable. Figure 6.1 holds the same child in two environments and shows two children. The counsellor's work is therefore often architectural: change the tempo, the threshold, the warning time, the volume of the room, the number of transitions — and watch the "symptoms" that were mismatches dissolve while the ones that were dispositions remain, manageable, in view.

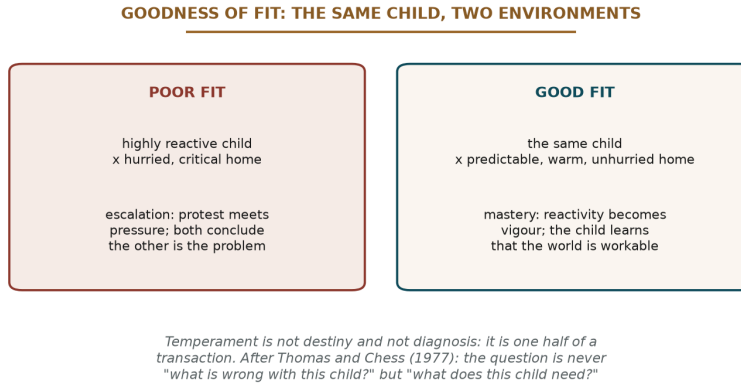


Figure 6.1 Goodness of fit: the same highly reactive child in a hurried, critical environment (escalation) and in a predictable, warm, unhurried one (mastery); temperament is one half of a transaction. After Thomas and Chess (1977). *Source:* prepared for this edition.

> **PRACTICE NOTE**
> **Clinical implication.** Write temperament into every formulation as its own line — reactivity, regulation, approach — and write the context's demands beside it. Where the two rows disagree, you have found free treatment: fit-work costs nothing but attention.

Lecture II — From co-regulation to self-regulation, via attachment

Regulation is built outside-in. The newborn's arousal is managed by the caregiver's body and voice; by six months, face and voice still carry most of it, and the still-face demonstration shows the infant working — turning away, self-comforting, collapsing — when the regulating face goes dead. Across the first year, responsive care converts signals into expectations: the child who is reliably met signals openly; the child whose bids are rejected or unanswered organises around

not bidding (volume 1, week 3); the child whose care is unpredictable escalates, because amplification has been the only reliable strategy.

These accumulated expectations are the internal working models — not diagnoses but habits of hope, carried into the nursery, the classroom and eventually the counselling room, where they will be tested against you within three sessions whether you notice or not. Two cautions belong here. First, working models are **revisable**: later responsive relationships edit them, which is the scientific warrant for every late intervention. Second, attachment categories describe **relationships and strategies**, never the worth of a mother; the science was built to describe care, and its misuse as blame is a corruption of it.

Conscience and self-control grow on the same stock: Kochanska's mutually responsive orientation — the warm, reciprocal partnership of early childhood — predicts conscience internalisation better than discipline style alone. The child cooperates with the regulation of someone they are in tune with; the child obeys the controller only while controlled.

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> Temperament language can launder blame: "difficult child" becomes the parent's alibi or the parent's indictment. The safeguard is the fit-frame in writing: records state the child's style, the context's demands, and the redesign attempted — never a child's character. And where a parent describes a baby as "bad" or "punishing me", hear it as a cry for co-regulation support and for the parent's own regulation: the referral that prevents harm is often to the parent's care, not the child's.

Worked example 6.1 — Ife at the doorway: a fit redesign

Task. Ife (3:8), slow-to-warm, intense, irregular in settling, spends twenty minutes at the nursery doorway each morning; staff report her as "anxious and manipulative". Redesign the fit.

Solution. First delete the adjectives: slow-to-warm is her style; twenty minutes is her regulation time; "manipulative" is a moral reading of a temperament–context mismatch. The context's demands, audited: arrival into a loud free-play room at peak time; goodbye required within one minute of entry because staff are busy; no warning sequence; a different greeter on most days. Four redesigns, in order of cost: (i) a **predictable greeter** — the same key worker receives her every day, because novelty taxes the withdrawing child most; (ii) a **threshold ritual** — goodbye at the gate, not the doorway, with the three-step sequence of week 4, so the transition is one, not three; (iii) **watching time honoured** — a seat at the edge from which Ife may watch as long as she needs, with the rule that watching is participation, announced to staff so no one pulls her in; (iv) **arrival before the crowd** — ten minutes early, when the room is quiet and the greeter is free. Expected course: twenty minutes to eight within three weeks, recorded daily.

If settling does not shorten, the hypothesis changes — to separation anxiety of clinical intensity (volume 1, week 5) or to something in the room we have not seen — and the record of the redesign is what makes that second look possible.

Worked example 6.2 — The parent who says "she is punishing me"

Task. Ife's mother, exhausted, says: "She does it to punish me for trading." Compose the counsel.

Solution. Three sentences, in order. Join: "You have been carrying twenty minutes of her crying and a full market day, every day, for months — of course you are tired enough to hear it as punishment." Reframe with mechanism: "She is not punishing you; she is a child whose system needs twenty minutes and one familiar face to change worlds, and right now the world changes too fast and with too many faces. It is her temperament meeting her nursery's timetable, not her heart meeting you." Turn to work: "We are going to change four things at the nursery and one at home — the goodbye ritual is yours, and it will be the thing she carries in her body when you are at the market. In three weeks we will count the minutes together." The reframe matters clinically as well as kindly: a parent who believes the child punishes is a parent whose co-regulation has collapsed into conflict, and the child's regulation cannot recover inside that belief.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 6 — the fit map. Take a referred child you know (anonymised) or a supplied case. Draw two columns: the child's temperament in five lines (reactivity, regulation, approach, rhythm, intensity); the context's demands in five lines (tempo, noise, transitions, novelty, adult availability). Circle every mismatch. Choose the two cheapest redesigns and write them as instructions a teacher could follow on Monday. 400 words; the mark is for redesigns that cost nothing but attention.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A goodness-of-fit analysis of 900 words on a supplied case: temperament profile, context audit, mismatch list, two redesigns with expected course and review date, and one paragraph on how you would write this in a record without a single adjective about character.

Criterion	Weight
Temperament described in dimensions, not adjectives	25%
Context audited with equal seriousness	25%
Redesigns concrete, cheap, reviewable	30%
Record language safeguarded against character-blame	20%

Formative. Record, verbatim, one co-regulation sentence you actually use with a distressed child, and analyse what it does to arousal (pace, pitch, predictability).

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. Temperament is the first draft of the person; attachment and co-regulation are the process by which regulation is borrowed until it is owned; and goodness of fit makes the context a treatment variable — so the practitioner writes style and demands side by side, redesigns the mismatches, protects the revisable working model, and refuses, in writing and in speech, to call a mismatch a character.

READING (APA 7TH)

- Ainsworth, M. D. S., Blehar, M. C., Waters, E., & Wall, S. N. (1978). *Patterns of attachment: A psychological study of the strange situation*. Lawrence Erlbaum.
- Berk, L. E. (2013). *Child development* (9th ed.). Pearson. — **core text**; emotional development chapters.
- Bowlby, J. (1969). *Attachment and loss: Vol. 1. Attachment*. Hogarth Press.
- Kochanska, G. (2002). Mutually responsive orientation between mothers and their young children: A context for the development of conscience. *Developmental Psychology, 38*(2), 183–195.
- Shonkoff, J. P., & Phillips, D. A. (Eds.). (2000). *From neurons to neighborhoods: The science of early childhood development*. National Academy Press.
- Thomas, A., & Chess, S. (1977). *Temperament and development*. Brunner/Mazel.

Seminar questions

1. "Difficult" is a relational adjective wearing a personal one. Give three contexts in which the same child is easy, and say what each context does differently.
2. Co-regulation makes the adult's nervous system part of the child's. What does that require of services that send dysregulated adults to dysregulated children?
3. Working models are revisable. What, realistically, revises them — and what is the counsellor's share of that work?
4. Where does goodness of fit stop being an explanation and start being an excuse for leaving an unjust context unchanged?
5. A parent says "she is punishing me". What is the developmental truth inside the sentence, and what is the pain inside it?

Next week

Week 7 follows the child's voice: how language is built from cooing to narrative, what bilingualism does and does not do, and the red flags that must never be waited out.

7 LECTURE UNIT 7 Teaching week 7 4 notional hours

Language and Communication: From Cooing to Narrative

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Sequence** the milestones of prelinguistic and linguistic communication and state the red-flag ages at which absence mandates hearing test and referral.
2. **Analyse** a short language sample: vocabulary breadth, word combinations, and the errors that are normal at a given age.
3. **Explain** what bilingual development is and is not: simultaneous and sequential acquisition, the silent period, and the myths that harm bilingual children.
4. **Describe** the input that builds language — responsive, conversational, book-sharing — and counsel a family on it without class contempt.
5. **Use** language development in counselling: matching the child's grammar, and reading a language history as part of every formulation.

Where this week sits

Language is the child's first technology and the counsellor's main medium; both facts are easy to forget. This week gives the developmental backbone of that medium — the milestone sequence with its points of no waiting, the social engine of input, and bilingualism described properly, because in the communities this programme serves, a child's strongest language will often not be the language of their school, their tests, or their therapist.

Key concepts

MILESTONE SEQUENCE

Cooing, babbling, first words around the first birthday, a fifty-word vocabulary with two-word combinations by roughly two years, telegraphic speech, the grammar explosion of the third year, and the narrative of the preschool years: a sequence robust across cultures, with wide normal variation around it. In the room: the map against which "late talker" becomes either a watchful wait or a referral.

RED FLAG

An absence at an age where presence is near-universal: no babbling or gesture by twelve months, no single word by eighteen, no two-word combinations by twenty-four. Not a diagnosis: a **referral point** — hearing first, always — because waiting is the only irreversible mistake in this field.

CONVERSATIONAL TURNS

The active ingredient of language input: contingent, back-and-forth exchange — the served and returned volley — which predicts language growth more strongly than the number of words a child overhears. In the room: the counsel that costs nothing: talk **with**, not at; follow the child's look; answer the point before the word.

SEQUENTIAL BILINGUALISM

Acquiring a second language after the first is established: with a normal **silent period** of comprehension before production, mixing and interference that are systematic rather than confused, and a temporary gap in the second language that is a sequence, not a disorder. In the room: the difference between a child learning a language and a child referred for not having one.

Lecture I — The sequence and its points of no waiting

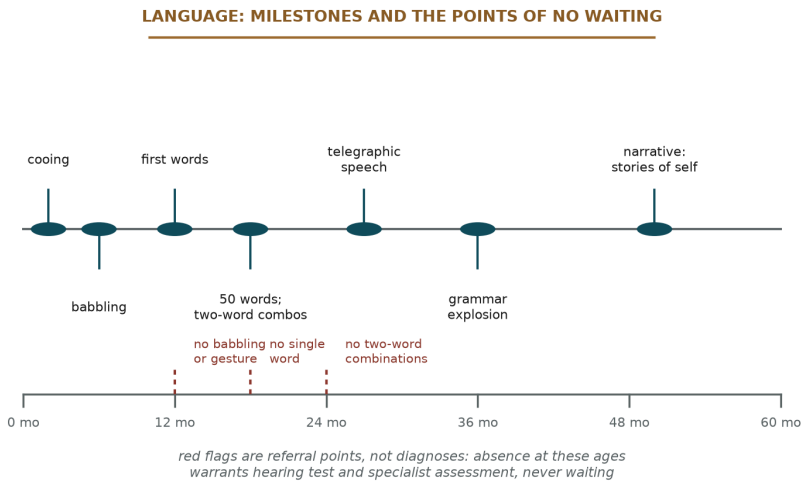


Figure 7.1 The language milestone timeline from cooing to narrative across the first sixty months, with the three red-flag ages at which absence mandates hearing assessment and referral rather than waiting. *Source:* prepared for this edition.

Proposition 1. Communication precedes language by months. Joint attention, gaze following, pointing — the declarative point that says "look with me"

— are the foundation on which words are laid; a twelve-month-old who does not point or show is a child to assess even if words later come, because the social engine matters as much as the vocabulary it drives.

Proposition 2. The first lexicon is built by fast mapping and errors that prove the system. Over-extension ("dog" for every animal) and under-extension are hypothesis-testing; two-word combinations obey a grammar of their own ("mummy sock", "more juice") that no one taught; the third year's morpheme errors ("goed", "foots") are the sound of rule discovery, and correcting them into silence teaches the child that speech is dangerous.

Proposition 3. Red flags are about absence, and absence has a first cause to exclude: hearing. Every late language presentation gets a hearing assessment before any other explanation is entertained — including the child who "hears the biscuit tin", because selective hearing of desired sounds coexists with high-frequency loss. The flags of Figure 7.1 are not norms to enforce but ages at which the cost of waiting exceeds the cost of assessing.

> **PRACTICE NOTE**
> **Clinical implication.** Take a language history on every child: first words, combinations, the language of the home and of the church and of the street, who talks with the child and when, and any period of silence and when it lifted. Four minutes that repeatedly dissolve false diagnoses and occasionally catch true ones.

Lecture II — Bilingualism, described without myths

Myth one: two languages confuse a child. They do not. Bilingual children reach the milestones of each language on the ordinary schedule **in that language**, mix languages within a sentence by rule rather than by confusion, and code-switch as competence, choosing the language of the listener when they can. **Myth two: a bilingual child's smaller vocabulary in each language is a delay.** Total conceptual vocabulary across two languages is ordinary; single-language counts understate a bilingual child, and every single-language test administered to them is a test of their exposure, not their capacity. **Myth three: the home language should be dropped for the school language to thrive.** The opposite: a strong first language is the scaffold the second is built on, and the family that abandons its language loses the conversations in which the child's mind grows — and loses the language of comfort, which is the language therapy will one day need.

The **silent period** of the sequential bilingual — weeks or months of comprehension before production — is normative and protective: the child is building the system before risking the performance. The counsel to a school that calls it mutism: date it, support it with comprehension input and gesture, and review at three months; selective mutism (week 12) speaks in some contexts and not others,

whereas the silent period speaks at home fluently — the discrimination is one question to a parent.

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> Language is a safeguarding instrument: a child's disclosure arrives in their strongest language, and an interpreter who is a family member is not an interpreter — least of all where the family member is implicated. Where a child's language is not the service's, the record must state which language the child was assessed in and by whom; an assessment in a weak language is not evidence about the child.

Worked example 7.1 — A language sample, analysed kindly

Task. Ten minutes of play with Ife (3:8) yields: "mummy go market", "me want red cup", "doggy runned fast", "why the sky crying?", "me no like that man him shout". Analyse.

Solution. Combinations of three to four words with subject–verb–object order: within expectation at 3:8. "runned": over-regularisation of the past morpheme — evidence of rule acquisition, to be celebrated in the record, not corrected in the room. "me want": pronoun case error, ordinary at this age and gone by four to five in most children. "why the sky crying": a causal question with animist framing (week 3) — the cognitive system working exactly on schedule. The last utterance is not grammar data at all: it is content — a named man who shouts — and the sample's most important line, to be followed in safeguarding terms rather than linguistic ones. The record therefore carries two conclusions: language development within the expected range for age in her home language, with the note that any school-language assessment will understate her; and a disclosure to be pursued this week. Analysis that hears only the morphemes has missed the child.

Worked example 7.2 — The red flag and the waiting parent

Task. Kunle's classmate (24 months) has no two-word combinations, single words around eight, no pointing at twelve by mother's recall. The mother says the neighbour's child spoke at three and "boys are late". Counsel and act.

Solution. Act first, kindly: the twenty-four-month flag is met; the pathway is hearing assessment now, in parallel with a developmental language assessment — not after a waiting period, because the waiting period is the harm. Counsel the mother with the neighbour's child honoured and the population stated: some children do speak late and thrive, and no one can tell at twenty-four months which late talkers those are — which is exactly why the assessment is free of cost to her and the waiting is not free to him. Give her the mechanism sentence: language is built in turns of conversation, and the assessment will tell us whether his ears, his processing or his opportunities are the bottleneck, because each has a different

remedy. Give her work for the fortnight that is also treatment: narrate the market, count the peppers, wait five seconds after every question, and let him be wrong aloud without correction. Review date written on the card: hearing result and sample in two weeks, no exceptions.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 7 — the ten-minute sample. Record ten minutes of child-led play with a child whose first language you share (or use a supplied recording). Transcribe twenty utterances verbatim. Code: word count per utterance, combinations present, one morpheme error, one evidence of rule use, one communicative function beyond requesting (comment, question, protest). Write 200 words: where this child sits against the sequence, and the one sentence of counsel to the caregiver. Bring the transcript to week 14's portfolio.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A language sample analysis: your coded transcript plus 600 words placing the child on the milestone sequence, naming one red flag you checked for and how, and stating the child's languages and which one you assessed.

Criterion	Weight
Transcript verbatim, coding accurate	30%
Placement on sequence with age-appropriate errors read as competence	30%
Red-flag check and hearing logic stated	20%
Languages of the child named and respected	20%

Formative. Write the three-sentence counsel to a parent advised by family to drop the home language.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. Language develops by a robust sequence on a social engine: communication before words, rules discovered through honourable errors, red flags that mandate hearing assessment rather than waiting, and bilingualism that is competence rather than confusion — so the practitioner samples before they judge, assesses in the child's language, and protects the home tongue as the child's instrument of thought and of comfort.

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Seminar questions

1. Why is overhearing not enough? What does the conversational turn supply that the radio does not?
2. "Boys are late." What is true in the sentence, what is dangerous in it, and how do you counsel inside it?
3. A bilingual child is tested in the school language and referred. Trace the error and the record that would have prevented it.
4. Over-regularisation is intelligence audible. Which other "errors" in childhood are the same?
5. If the home language is the language of comfort, what does that imply for a therapy conducted in a school language?

Next week

Week 8 asks who the child takes themselves to be: self-concept, Erikson's crises, and the development of moral reasoning — including the critique that changed how moral development is taught.

8 LECTURE UNIT 8 Teaching week 8 4 notional hours

Self, Identity and Moral Development

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Trace** the development of self-concept from physical and possessory description to psychological and comparative self, and state what self-esteem does across childhood.
2. **Apply** Erikson's childhood crises — trust, autonomy, initiative, industry, identity — as a formulation instrument, naming what each unresolved balance looks like in the room.
3. **Sequence** moral reasoning from Piaget's realism through Kohlberg's levels, and **state** Gilligan's and social-domain critiques precisely.
4. **Describe** conscience and prosocial development as relationship-built rather than rule-taught.

5. **Interview** a child about a moral dilemma and code the reasoning, not the verdict.

Where this week sits

A child enters counselling with a working theory of who they are and what they owe — built from being met or not met, trusted or not trusted, able or not able. This week is that theory's development: the self that describes itself, the crises that organise it, and the moral reasoning that justifies it. It closes the volume's first movement; from week 9 the child meets other people.

Key concepts

SELF-CONCEPT
The child's working description of themselves: physical and possessory at three ("I have a red cup"), behavioural and comparative in the primary years ("I can run faster than Tobi"), psychological and trait-based from late childhood, and in adolescence an integrated identity — with the school-age dip in which the child discovers that others rank them. In the room: the register in which the child can hear you; praise pitched above the child's self-concept is not heard.

ERIKSONIAN CRISIS
Each childhood period poses a social crisis whose balance is carried forward: trust v. mistrust (hope), autonomy v. shame (will), initiative v. guilt (purpose), industry v. inferiority (competence), identity v. role confusion (fidelity). Not stages that pass but balances that persist as dispositions. In the room: the shortest useful history — which balance did this child mostly meet?

MORAL REASONING
Piaget's move from realism (rules as external, outcome-based judgement) to relativism (intent, agreement); Kohlberg's levels — preconventional (consequences and exchange), conventional (relationships and law), postconventional (principle) — as reasoning about justice, scored from justification, never from choice. In the room: the seven-year-old who judges by damage is not immoral; they are seven.

CONSCIENCE
Internalised self-regulation with an emotional core: guilt that repairs rather than shame that hides, built in mutually responsive relationships and through induction ("look at her face — she is crying because…") rather than through power assertion. In the room: the difference between a child who stops because someone might see and a child who stops because someone else hurts.

Lecture I — The self, built in mirrors that are people

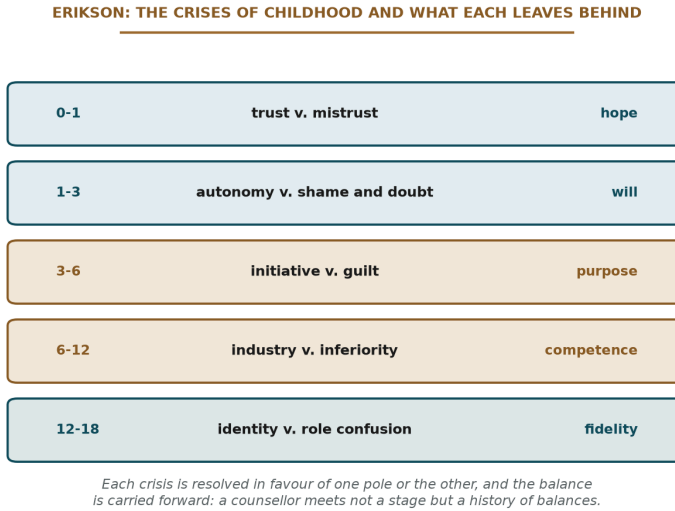


Figure 8.1 Erikson's childhood crises with their ages and the strength each leaves behind: hope, will, purpose, competence, fidelity; each balance is carried forward into the next crisis and into the counselling room. *Source:* prepared for this edition.

Proposition 1. The self is social before it is personal. The infant's sense of agency (I make the rattle move), the mirror and rouge recognitions of the second year, the possession-language of the third ("mine!") that adults misread as selfishness when it is selfhood: each is built in interaction, and each can be read back from it. The school-age child's self-concept is comparative because school is comparative — and the dip in self-esteem around eight to twelve is the child discovering the ranking, not a disorder of confidence.

Proposition 2. Erikson's balances are the counsellor's shortest anamnesis. The child who cannot trust the room (mistrust carried), who cannot choose without shame (autonomy defeated), who proposes nothing (initiative punished), who expects to be bad at everything before trying (industry defeated), who is no one in particular and terrified of it (identity diffuse) — five sentences, each with a history, each with a different therapeutic task. Figure 8.1 is a history-taking form wearing a diagram's clothes.

Proposition 3. Adolescent identity work begins earlier than adolescence. The primary-years industry crisis is identity's foundation: competence experienced is the material identity is later built from; the child whose industry was defeated arrives at fifteen without raw material, and the identity confusion then looks like laziness to everyone but the developmental reader.

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. Pitch your language at the child's self-concept: with the under-six, concrete and possessory ("you worked hard on that tower"); with the school-age, behavioural and effort-based, never trait-based ("you kept going" not "you are clever"), because trait praise collapses at the first failure and teaches the child to hide from difficulty.

Lecture II — Moral reasoning and its critiques

Piaget watched children play marbles and judge stories: the young child's morality is realist — rules are external and unchangeable, and the child who breaks twelve cups by accident is naughtier than the child who broke one stealing jam, because damage is the measure. By roughly ten, intent governs and rules become agreements. Kohlberg generalised the sequence into levels and stages using dilemmas (Heinz and the drug above all), scoring the **reason** given, never the choice made.

Gilligan's critique, precisely stated: Kohlberg's instrument prized a justice-and-rights voice and scored a care-and-responsibility voice lower; women and girls in his samples appeared "less developed" by a yardstick built from boys' answers. The correction is not that care replaces justice but that moral maturity has two registers, and an instrument blind to one mis-measures whoever speaks it. **Social-domain theory's critique**, equally important for practice: children do not reason morally about everything at once — they distinguish, from early, the moral (harm, fairness), the conventional (school rules, dress) and the personal (my hair, my friend), and much adult–child conflict is a domain dispute: the adult arguing convention as if it were morality, the child defending the personal as if it were a right.

Conscience and prosocial development grow in relationship, not in lecture: induction — drawing the child's attention to the other's feeling and the repair available — builds guilt-that-repairs; power assertion builds compliance-that-vanishes-when-unwatched; and prosocial behaviour follows empathy's development, from reactive crying in infancy to helping that costs the helper something by the primary years (Eisenberg and colleagues). The child who shares because they are watched is at an earlier station, not a worse soul.

SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT

Moral reasoning knowledge protects children in two directions. First, from adult over-reading: a seven-year-old's outcome-based judgement is not callousness, and a child's lie to escape punishment is preconventional reasoning doing its job — punish the lie as character and you teach concealment. Second, from adult under-reading: children distinguish moral from conventional early, so a child who says "that rule is stupid but I follow it" and a child who says "hitting is wrong even if teacher doesn't

> see" are making different claims, and the second is the conscience you are building on. Records of a child's "immorality" are usually records of their age; write the age.

Worked example 8.1 — The cup story with Kunle, coded

Task. Tell Kunle (7) the standard pair: child A opens the cupboard for a sweet and knocks fifteen cups down; child B takes a sweet they were told not to and knocks one cup down. Who is naughtier, and why? Code.

Solution. Kunle: "A. Him break plenty." Asked whether A meant to: "no, e just open." Asked if that matters: "the cups still break." Code: realism / outcome-based judgement with intent acknowledged but not weighted — the expected profile at seven, sitting at the realism-to-relativism transition. The record's value is the justification, and the follow-up question that locates the zone: "if A was helping mummy and B was hiding from mummy, which one would you tell mummy about?" — Kunle hesitates, then "B... because e hide." The hesitation is the zone: intention is entering the system under social framing. Next teaching step (week 4's scaffold): stories in which intent and outcome are pitted with the child as judge, then as author. And the Erikson line in the same record: Kunle's industry — "I don't want to write because my writing is bad" — names the balance to protect this term; moral work and industry work will run in the same sessions, because a child who expects to be wrong judges himself by outcomes too.

Worked example 8.2 — The domain dispute in the staffroom

Task. A teacher demands that a nine-year-old apologise for refusing to cut his long hair: "it is school rule and he must respect rules". Advise, using social-domain theory.

Solution. Name the domains aloud: hair is in the personal domain for the child and, in this school's code, in the conventional domain for the institution — and the conflict is real but not moral; no one has been harmed, and demanding an apology recruits the moral register ("respect", "sorry") for a conventional dispute, which teaches the child that all rules are moral and all disobedience is sin, and buys the school a resentment it will pay for at thirteen. Advise the sequence: (i) uphold the institution's right to a dress code transparently, as convention, with its reason stated ("our code says X because Y"); (ii) withdraw the moral demand — no apology required for a domain claim; (iii) give the child a voice within the convention (a hearing, a review date, an exemption route), which is how conventions earn allegiance; (iv) watch the child's own reasoning — if he argues "my body, my choice", he is making a personal-domain claim worth hearing developmentally, not a disciplinary offence. The teacher leaves with a distinction that will save a dozen relationships: morality is about harm and fairness; convention is about how we run this place; and children can tell them apart long before staffrooms can.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 8 — the moral interview. Interview two children of different ages with the cup stories and one personal–conventional probe ("Is it wrong to wear red socks here if the school says white? Is it wrong to hit? Why the difference?"). Code each: realism/relativism or level; domain distinctions present or absent; register (justice, care, or both). Write 300 words comparing the two children's reasoning and naming one teaching step for each. The mark is on the coding of justifications.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A moral reasoning interview record with coding, plus 600 words: the child's Eriksonian balances as you read them from the session and the file, and one intervention pitched at the child's self-concept register.

Criterion	Weight
Justifications recorded verbatim and coded correctly	35%
Domain distinctions analysed	20%
Erikson applied as history, not label	25%
Intervention pitched at the child's self-concept	20%

Formative. One paragraph: which Eriksonian balance was mostly met in your own childhood, and what it costs you to defend it in others.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. The self is built in social mirrors and carries its Eriksonian balances forward; moral reasoning moves from outcome to intent across the primary years in two registers, justice and care, inside a mind that distinguishes moral, conventional and personal from early — so the practitioner codes justifications, pitches praise at the child's register, builds conscience by induction and repair, and refuses to moralise a domain dispute or an age.

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Seminar questions

1. Trait praise collapses at first failure. What does effort praise do instead, and why does it survive?
2. A child lies to escape punishment. Write the developmental sentence, the moral sentence, and the counsel sentence — and say which order you would speak them in.
3. Gilligan's critique is often summarised as "women are care-oriented". What is wrong with that summary, and what is lost by it?
4. Which domain is a school uniform rule in, and what changes if a school argues it as morality?
5. Which Eriksonian balance do you defend too quickly in the children you meet, and what in your own history is defending it?

Next week

Week 9 sends the child out to meet equals: peer relations, the development of friendship, the stages of play, and the four accounts of gender development argued against each other.

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